



INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY OF COMPARATIVE EDUCATION, SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, NIGERIA

ISCEST NEWS

is produced quarterly.

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ISCEST NEWS

Issue 1

March 2025

Proud Moments for ISCEST!

Founding President of ISCEST, Professor Steve Azaiki OON, is chair of the Aduvie International School Board. Its meeting was held on 03 April 2025. Also present at the Board Meeting was the immediate past President of ISCEST, Professor Nedie Akani.



Professor Steve Azaiki

The Guest of Honour at this meeting was His Excellency, Dr. Goodluck Ebele Jonathan, GCFR (President of FGN, 2010 -2015), who presented the goodwill message. There were eleven other Board Members present at this meeting.



HE Dr Goodluck Jonathan greets Professor Nedie Akani at the Board Meeting

ISCEST is proud to be associated with a school that establishes itself as the *home of international-mindedness*, and has global-mindedness as one of its core values. This is not an idle characteristic that the school has taken on, for its staff and pupils have representations from four different countries of the world. During the spring of each year, learners travel to selected countries to participate in various activities. ISCEST looks forward to participating in future activities and projects that the Aduvie International School is planning to engage in.

See pages 2 &3 for the Chair's Opening Remarks.

Publish Your Research Paper in CSCEST!



Current Studies in Comparative Education, Science and Technology (CSCEST) is ISCEST's Official Journal. The journal promotes interdisciplinary studies in education, science and technology. It publishes original research and papers that discuss, analyse or evaluate policies, or those that disclose relevant gaps in existing research. For more information on paper submission please visit <http://www.journal.iscest.org/>.

Opening Remarks by Professor Steve Azaiki OON—Aduvie International School Board Meeting, 03 April 2025

Your Excellency, Dr. Goodluck Ebele Jonathan, GCFR (President of FGN, 2010 -2015),
Distinguished Board Members,
Director of Aduvie International Schools,
Respected Head of School,
Esteemed Members of the Management Team, and Staff,



Professor Steve Azaiki

Good morning and welcome to this significant gathering of the Board of Aduvie International Schools. It is both an honor and a privilege to stand before you today in my capacity as Board Chairman to formally welcome and express our profound gratitude to His Excellency Dr. Goodluck Ebele Jonathan, President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria (2010–2015), who has graciously honored us with his esteemed presence to deliver a goodwill message at the inauguration of the Aduvie Board of Trustees. Your Excellency, we are deeply appreciative of your magnanimous acceptance of our invitation, extended on less than twelve hours' notice. Your presence here today is a testament to your enduring commitment and support, for which we remain sincerely grateful.

Let me also extend my heartfelt appreciation to the esteemed members of the previous board who have been reappointed to serve once again. Your immense contributions and unwavering commitment to the growth and success of this institution have been invaluable. I take this moment to recognize each of you by name:

- **Anthony Chukwuemeka Nzom**, a distinguished Nigerian accountant and former President of the Association of National Accountants of Nigeria (ANAN), whose tenure was marked by fostering collaborations with ICAN, PAFA, and ABWA to elevate accounting standards across the region.
- **Fatimah Suleiman Ahmed**, an accomplished public health professional leading disease surveillance in FCT, who played a pivotal role in Nigeria's COVID-19 response as the Epidemiology and Point of Entry Pillar lead. As National Treasurer of EPISON, she remains dedicated to preventive healthcare and health system resilience.
- **Muhammad Bala Shagari**, a distinguished leader whose illustrious career spans military service, entrepreneurship, and public administration, with milestones including co-founding Hamadah Shipping with Aliko Dangote, leading key agricultural and electrification initiatives, and serving as the revered Sarkin Mafara of Shagari.
- **Barr. (Mrs.) Joy Sheila Bob-Manuel**, a trailblazing Nigerian lawyer whose leadership as Director-General of the Legal Aid Council and unwavering dedication to social justice have left an indelible mark on advocating for the underprivileged and marginalized communities. Your dedication has truly set a high standard, and we are grateful for your continued service. To our newly appointed Board Members, I extend a warm and enthusiastic welcome:
- **Professor Obanishola M. Sadiq**, a renowned Nigerian structural engineer and academic, celebrated for his expertise in structural engineering analysis, modeling, and stability.
- **Professor Akani Nedie Patience**, a distinguished microbiologist at Rivers State University with expertise in Environmental Microbiology and Public Health, with over 100 scientific publications and significant leadership roles, including Head of Department and President of ISCEST.
- **Professor Ogbonnaya Ogbu**, a seasoned academic leader, former Dean of the Faculty of Applied and Natural Sciences for eight years, pioneer Dean of the Faculty of Biological Sciences, and current Director of Ebonyi State University Consultancy Services Limited.
- **Kayode Adeoti**, an experienced professional with over 25 years in technical and business development roles, currently serving as a Customer Care Officer at MTN Nigeria.
- **Shafie Abdulkadir Hassan**, a celebrated visionary with nearly three decades of trailblazing leadership across sustainable development, finance, and global value chains; whose international expertise, groundbreaking initiatives, and transformative impact across industries have made him a sought-after voice and mentor on the world stage.

Cont'd from Page 2

- **Dr. Rilwan Bamgbala**, a Nigerian entrepreneur and business executive with significant ventures in Russia, holding a Ph.D. in Chemistry from the Russian State University of Oil and Gas (Gubkin).

- **Omieibi Edward Fiberesima**, Aduvie International School's first Student Council President, who set a legacy of leadership. Now a final-year medical student at the University of Kragujevac, Serbia, he also serves as the National Secretary of The Church of Pentecost, Serbia. His excellence extends beyond academics into music production, collaborating internationally with millions of listeners.

Your expertise and experience are highly valued, and we are confident that your presence will add tremendous strength to our collective efforts. We look forward to working together to elevate Aduvie International Schools to even greater heights.

I would also like to express my profound gratitude to the Director of Aduvie International Schools, **Dr. (Mrs.) Ayima Lott-Jonathan** - a distinguished educationist, lawyer, and visionary leader, with a wealth of academic achievements and a deep passion for shaping well-rounded children - for

reappointing me to the Board. It is a privilege to serve alongside such distinguished colleagues in shaping the future of education and contributing to the socioeconomic development of our great nation through this institution.

As we reflect on our journey, it is remarkable to witness the progress made by Aduvie International School over the years. Through the dedication of the Director, the Head of School, Management, and Staff, the school has continuously raised the bar in academic excellence, holistic education, and infrastructural development. Today, Aduvie International School proudly stands as one of the best schools in Nigeria. This is not just a statement; it is a reality that I have personally experienced.

A testimony to this excellence is the educational journey of my daughter, **Sinikiem Azaiki**, who completed her secondary education at Aduvie at the age of 15 as the overall best graduating student. She then moved to Canada and continued to excel academically. She later enrolled in Ukraine, but her studies were interrupted by the Russia-Ukraine war. Despite the challenges, she completed the remaining six months of her four-year program online and earned a BSc degree in Software Engineering from Kiev Aviation University. This year, she is also set to graduate from Centennial College Toronto in Computer Engineering.

My second daughter, **Enieni Azaiki**, also distinguished herself academically at Aduvie, winning a prize for academic excellence. She is graduating this year with distinction from Clark Atlanta University in the United States.

My youngest daughter, a proud product of Aduvie, showed remarkable resilience in the face of adversity. Despite battling cancer, she excelled in her WASSCE examinations and is now pursuing her studies at the University of Prince Edward Island in Charlottetown, Canada. These personal experiences reaffirm my belief in the exceptional standard of education provided by Aduvie International School.

Given the outstanding facilities and state-of-the-art amenities available on our school grounds, I firmly believe that Aduvie International School has the potential to evolve into a full-fledged world-class university. This is an aspiration that the Board will fully support and work towards in the coming years. The foundation has been laid, and it is now our collective responsibility to explore this possibility with strategic planning and execution.

Currently, the school offers a robust Pre-University program, an initiative that has been instrumental in preparing students for higher education. This program was previously overseen by the esteemed late **Prof. Adebisi Daramola**, former Vice-Chancellor of the Federal University of Technology, Akure (FUTA). His passing was a great loss, not just to this institution but to the academic community as a whole. I had the honor of working closely with him while serving on the Governing Council of FUTA, where I chaired the committee that confirmed his appointment as substantive Vice-Chancellor. His contributions were immense, and we will forever remember his legacy.

As we embark on this new phase, I have no doubt that the newly constituted Board, enriched by decades of collective experience, will bring fresh perspectives and innovative solutions to advance the mission of Aduvie International Schools. I look forward to meaningful deliberations and actionable outcomes from our engagements today and in the future.

Once again, I thank you all for your dedication and commitment. Your willingness to serve on the Board, knowing there is no remuneration for the role, is a true show of patriotism and deep interest in the human capital development of our nation. Let us continue to work together to make Aduvie International Schools a beacon of educational excellence in Nigeria and beyond.

Thank you, and I wish us all a successful meeting.

A Glimpse of Professor Akani's Experience at Federal University, Otuoke



4th from left: Professor Nedie Akani

During my sabbatical leave at Federal University, Otuoke, I had the privilege of engaging with final-year Microbiology students and participating in the 1st International Conference organized by the Faculty of Science.

Through teaching, mentoring, and supervising seminars and undergraduate research topics, I shared my knowledge and expertise with the students, guiding them in developing research skills, critical thinking, and effective communication. This experience not only deepened my understanding of the academic and professional aspirations of young scholars but also instilled in me a sense of fulfilment and purpose.

Participating in the international conference, further broadened my perspectives, providing a platform for knowledge sharing, networking, and collaboration with global experts. Engaging with colleagues from diverse backgrounds enriched my academic and professional growth, sparking new ideas and insights that I can apply in my future endeavours.

Professor Nedie Patience Akani

(Cont'd on Page 6)

Congratulations to Professor Akani!



The ISCEST Family takes this opportunity to extend heartfelt congratulations to its immediate Former President, Professor Nedie Akani for participating in the 1st International Conference of the Faculty of Science, Federal University Otuoke.



Professor Akani's Experience (Con'd from Page 4)



4th from left: Professor Nedie Akani

Having spent only seven months of a twelve-month Sabbatical leave at the Federal University, Otuoke, I would title my experience thus: "A Rewarding Sabbatical: Mentoring Future Microbiologists at Federal University, Otuoke"

As a Professor of Environmental Microbiology and Public Health in the Federal University, Otuoke, I was engaged in academic and professional development I had the privilege of interacting with final-year Microbiology students. This experience was not only enriching but also provided valuable insights into the academic and professional aspirations of these young scholars.

Engagement with students during this period accorded me the opportunity to teach, mentor, and interact with the final-year Microbiology students. I was impressed by their eagerness to learn, their curiosity, and their passion for the field of Microbiology. Through lectures, practical sessions, and one-on-one interactions, I shared my knowledge and expertise with them, and also learned from their perspectives and experience.

Profiling Professor Etela

ISCEST held its first 2025 Webinar on 09 April 2025. The theme was:

Shaping Education 4.0 in Africa Through University - Vocational Education and Training Systems

This theme was presented by Prof. Ibisime Etela, (RAS) University of Port Harcourt, Nigeria. The purpose of the presentation was:

- To increase awareness and promote implementation of Education 4.0 for healthy collaboration among tertiary institutions and vocational education and training systems in Africa for sustainable development.



Professor Ibisime Etela

Here is **Introduction (I)** from his presentation:

- Education and what it means - basically, knowledge transfer
- Comparing university versus technical vocational education and training (TVET) - more preference for university education without good knowledge about TVET education system
- The concept of education for sustainable development (ESD) - education, which responds the needs and expectations of the sustainable development goals

About Professor Etela

- 12 months Research for Development Advisor, Hydrocarbon Pollution Remediation Project, Federal Ministry of Environment
- 5 years research-for-development (RfD) experience with the International Livestock Research Institute (ILRI), Ibadan, Oyo State, Nigeria
- 12 months Research Advisor to Shell Petroleum Development Company of Nigeria Limited, Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Nigeria
- Assistant Coordinator, Regional Centre of Expertise Greater Port Harcourt (RCE Port Harcourt—[www.https://rceporttharcourt.com.rg](https://rceporttharcourt.com.rg))
- Procurement Officer, World Bank Africa Centre of Excellence in Oilfield Chemicals Research (ACE-CEFOR—<https://aceceforuniport.edu.ng>)
- Two-Term Dean, Faculty of Agriculture, University of Port Harcourt (UniPort)
- Professor, Department of Animal Science, UniPort

NB: More information from Professor Etela's presentation will be presented in subsequent issues of ISCEST News

Meet the Members of the Aduvie International School Board!

Chair—Professor Steve Azaiki



1st from left: Immediate Past President ISCEST, Professor Nedie Akanie; 3rd from right: Professor Steve Azaiki

1. Mr. Anthony Nzom, Former President ANAN (Association of National Accountants of Nigeria)
2. Mrs Fatima Ahmed, Renowned Public Health Professional serving as National Treasure of EPI-SON
3. Mrs Joy Bob-Manuel, Former DG of the Legal Aid Council of Nigerian
4. Alh Mohammed Shagari, Revered traditional ruler (Sarkin Mafara of Shagari) and Entrepreneur
5. Prof Sadiq Obanishola, Renowned Nigerian Structural Engineer and Academic
6. Prof Nedie Patience Akani, Distinguished Professor of Environmental Microbiology & Public Health & Immediate Past President of ISCEST Nigeria
7. Prof Ogbonmaya Ogbu, Seasoned Academic Leader & Current Director of Ebonyi State University Consultancy Services Limited
8. Mr. Kayode Adeoti, Experienced IT Professional & Current Customer Care Officer, MTN Nigeria
9. Mr. Abdulkadir Hassan, Global Finance Expert
10. Dr. Rilwan Bamgbala, Remarkable Nigerian Entrepreneur
11. Mr Omieibi Fibaresima, First Student Council President of Aduvie International School.

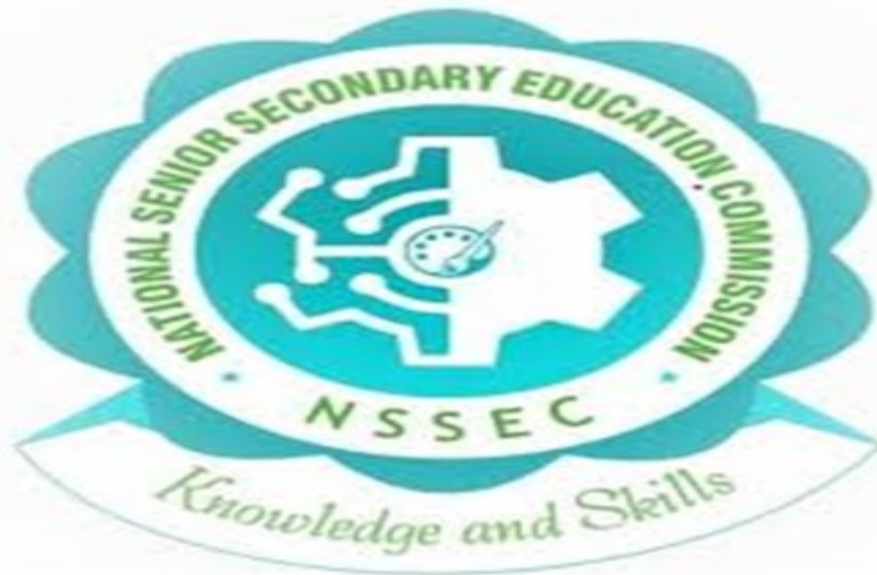
Some Memories of the April 3 Meeting! (From p.2)



NSSEC Drives Math Excellence

NSSEC Drives Math Excellence through strategic partnership with National Mathematical Center

By NSSEC Admin April 11, 2025



Abuja, April 11, 2025 – The National Senior Secondary Education Commission (NSSEC), under the leadership of the Executive Secretary Dr. Iyela Ajayi, hosted a high-level delegation from the National Mathematical Center (NMC), led by the Director-General Prof. Promise Medini, to discuss collaborative efforts in advancing training, learning and research in mathematical sciences.

During the meeting, Dr. Ajayi emphasized NSSEC's pivotal role in enhancing senior secondary education, outlining key initiatives such as teacher training, provision of math kits, and national competitions to boost student performance in mathematics, computer science, and statistics.

“NSSEC is committed to fostering strategic partnerships that elevate educational standards,” said Dr. Ajayi, reaffirming the commission’s dedication to empowering Nigerian students through innovative learning approaches.

The NMC delegation commended NSSEC’s leadership and expressed enthusiasm for the collaboration, which aims to strengthen mathematics for national development.

Source: <https://nssec.gov.ng/nssec-drives-math-excellence-through-strategic-partnership-with-national-mathematical-center/>

Attend International Education Conferences!

Europe Universities Summit

Pairing Higher Education Excellence
with World- Leading Research and Innova-
tion

**6–9 May 2025
Budapest, Hungary**

ICEDU 2025

The 11th International Conference on Education 2025

Theme: “Cultivating Global Citizen Skills through Research
and Education: Development of critical thinking, creativity,
communication and collaboration”

April 07th – 09th, 2025

Bangkok, Thailand



**2025 EFMD Conference for Quality, Impact and Accredi-
tation Professionals**

Quality, accreditation, and impact in the age of AI: Chal-
lenges and opportunities

Face to Face

14 May - 16 May

Barcelona, Spain

virginie.heredia-rosa@efmdglobal.org

The 21st Biennial Conference of the International Study
Association on Teachers & Teaching

University of Glasgow, 30 June - 4 July 2025



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ISCEST President Says “Thank You!”

Greetings to all!

It is about three months now since I was elected as President of ISCEST. I wish to use this medium to extend heartfelt thanks to the ISCEST family for entrusting me with this auspicious task. Be assured that I will continue to uphold the values of this distinguished and progressive organisation.



Professor Matthew Wegwu

ISCEST convenes its XII Annual International Conference in December of this year. As soon as the dates and venue are finalised, the information will be posted on the various ISCEST media platforms. As in previous years, the focus will be on Comparative Education, Science and Technology. Do make an effort to participate.

Professor Matthew Wegwu
President—ISCEST

THANK YOU ISCEST FAMILY!

To Our Supporters and Friends!

When the ISCEST family is thankful
It expresses sincere gratitude to show
How very grateful we truly are
That you help us develop and grow

Gertrude Shotte

